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DJIA 51078.88 ▲ 46.42 0.09% NASDAQ 27086.81 ▲ 0.4% STOXX 600 621.24 ▼ 0.8% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 6/32, yield 4.475% OIL \$92.16 ▲ \$4.80 GOLD \$4,475.20 ▼ \$85.30 EURO \$1.1632 YEN 159.67

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Anthropic**, the artificial-intelligence lab recently valued at nearly \$1 trillion, said that it filed confidentially for an initial public offering, setting up a blockbuster year for IPOs. **A1**
- ◆ **Nvidia unveiled** the prototypes of a new generation of personal laptop computers designed to run AI agents using newly designed version of the company's chips. **B1**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks rose**, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow gaining 0.3%, 0.4% and 0.1%, respectively, while benchmark U.S. crude futures closed 5.5% higher at \$92.16 a barrel. **B1**
- ◆ **Google parent Alphabet** said it would issue \$80 billion in equity to finance capital spending tied to AI. **B1**
- ◆ **Factory activity** continued to expand in the U.S. for the fifth consecutive month in May, a survey reported. **A2**
- ◆ **Prominent short seller** Andrew Left was convicted of securities fraud over federal charges that he used his public calls on stocks to manipulate their prices. **B3**
- ◆ **The bitcoin-hoarding** firm Strategy said it sold \$2.5 million in bitcoin last week, its first sale since 2022. **B1**
- ◆ **Global infrastructure** provider GLP plans to raise as much as \$3 billion via an initial public offering. **B11**
- ◆ **Motorola Solutions** signed a deal to buy D-Fend for \$1.5 billion, adding counter-drone technologies to its products and services. **B4**
- ◆ **JetBlue said it is** enjoying strong demand in all the places it operates even as high fuel costs are driving up fares. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Trump aimed to quash** a growing conflict between Israel and Hezbollah that threatened to derail his peace talks with Iran, declaring that both sides had agreed to stop fighting. **A1**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** said it would abide by a judge's order directing the government to temporarily halt work on Trump's nearly \$1.8 billion compensation fund. **A4**
- ◆ **Florida sued OpenAI** and its chief executive, Sam Altman, alleging that they knowingly released ChatGPT as an unsafe product and ignored warnings that it could harm users. **A4**
- ◆ **New York City's** Economic Development Corporation remains without a chief executive, raising concern among businesspeople in real estate and finance. **A3**
- ◆ **Defense Secretary** Pete Hegseth blocked the promotion of eight Navy captains to be one-star admirals, including two female and two Black officers. **A3**
- ◆ **A Trump administration** policy illegally banned transgender troops from military service, a divided panel of federal appeals court judges ruled. **A2**
- ◆ **Russia sent a cargo ship** to resupply its air base in Syria, a signal the Kremlin intends to maintain the asset under the country's new rulers. **A6**
- ◆ **University of California** math and science professors urged regents to reinstate entrance exams, arguing that unprepared students are lowering academic standards and draining teaching resources. **A3**
- ◆ **Died: Raymond Berry**, 93, NFL wide receiver. **A2**

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Kenyans Protest U.S. Plans for Ebola Center



ANDREW KASUKU/ASSOCIATED PRESS

UNDER FIRE: A protester raises a Kenyan flag near a burning barricade during a demonstration against a proposed Ebola quarantine center to be established by the U.S. in Kenya. Americans exposed to Ebola while abroad would be sent there. **A9**

Autism Therapy Is Booming—And So Is the Billing Abuse

Insurers flag fraud, exorbitant charges; a parent's surprise bill for \$911,400

By CHRISTOPHER WEAVER
AND ANNA WILDE MATHEWS

Carolina Lopez searched for therapy services for her autistic son, Ezekiel, who was then 3 years old. But every provider she called had a wait list. "There seemed to not be much I could do," said Lopez, 33, a bank employee in Roselle Park, N.J.

A provider called the Perfect Child promised immediate

treatment—and no out-of-pocket costs.

Beginning last July, workers came to her home several days a week to provide three to four hours of therapy for Ezekiel.

In April, she got the bill: \$911,400.

The autism-therapy industry, once a tiny corner of pediatric care, has exploded into a multi-billion-dollar business, fueled by rising diagnoses, new providers entering the market and laws requiring insurers to cover more services. It has also attracted predatory providers who bill for phantom services, pad hours and charge steep fees for care delivered by low-wage workers

with minimal training.

The billing abuses run wide. Aetna said the number of investigations that found likely fraud or abusive billing by autism-therapy providers in its private-plan business shot up by 300% between 2024 and 2025—and is on track to rise by another 50% this year.

The issues detected by the insurer's probes include poor documentation, billing for multiple services for the same hour and claiming to provide care at home addresses that don't really exist, said Katerina Guerraz, Aetna's chief operating officer.

"We're seeing just a massive inflation," especially when pro-

viders are not in-network, Guerraz said.

In bills reviewed by The Wall Street Journal, a daily charge for one child reached more than \$30,000.

When insurers refuse to pay what they consider outlandish or unjustified claims, some providers pursue people directly, dragging families into financial and legal turmoil and disrupting care for disabled children. In Lopez's case, her insurer had rejected claims, and the therapy provider billed her instead.

Simcha Bendet, the founder of Brooklyn, N.Y.-based the Perfect Child, which says it pro-

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Media Mogul, 84, Reinvents Himself Yet Again

By JESSICA TOONKEL

At age 84, Barry Diller is reinventing himself. Again.

The studio executive-turned-digital-brand-builder-turned-publishing-magnate said on Monday that his company, People Incorporated, wanted to take over the rest of MGM Resorts in a deal valuing the casino giant at around \$12.4 billion.

As other investors are looking to tech to drive growth, Diller is going all-in on a casino company, betting the business is one that AI can't replace.

"While everyone was running into all sorts of 'AI opportunities,' I wanted to run the other way," Diller said in an interview. "It wasn't hard for me to find MGM, where no one is going to get in between those resorts and consumers until we get to the final simulation."

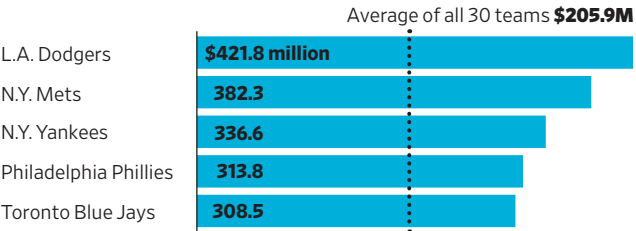
Diller has made a career of unexpected wagers. Back in 1992, at the age of 50, he left his job as CEO of Fox Inc. to go out on his own and start amassing stakes in small companies including QVC and Ticketmaster. He doubled down on digital, buying dating site Match and travel site Expedia, then went big on magazines by buying publisher Meredith in 2021. Just this year, Diller rebranded his company as People Incorporated.

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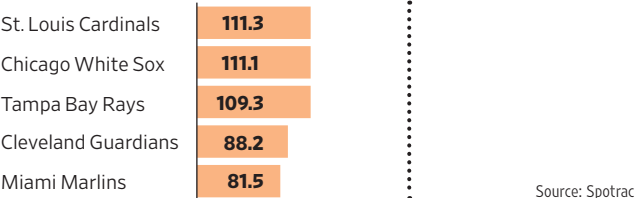
The Cost of an MLB Salary Cap

The current collective-bargaining agreement expires a month after the World Series, at which point owners are all but certain to initiate a lockout that could threaten the 2027 season. **A18**

Five highest MLB tax payrolls, 2026



Five lowest MLB tax payrolls, 2026



Britain's Elite Are in a Race To Save Their Favorite Relish

Decision to end production of anchovy spread is drawing a salty reaction

By JAMES HOOKWAY

LONDON—Nature abhors a vacuum. So, too, it seems, do English gentlemen.

When the makers of a salty condiment called Gentleman's Relish said poor sales couldn't justify producing it any longer, much of the British establishment mobilized to see if there was a way to save its favorite umami-rich anchovy paste.

At least three approaches were made to buy the brand, which is as ubiquitous to upper-class larders as French's mustard is to

New York hot-dog stands. Simpson's in the Strand, a luxuriously upholstered eatery in the center of London, came up with its own version. High-end department store Fortnum & Mason is selling its own a short walk away.

The Spectator magazine, a bible of sorts for the well-heeled, secured some of the last remaining pots of the stuff to distribute to readers as a prize for whoever submits the letter of the week.

In doing so, they are hoping to save a little taste of England

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Pot of gold?

Trump Seeks End To Lebanon Conflict

President Trump on Monday aimed to quash a growing conflict between Israel and Hezbollah that threatened to derail his peace talks with

By Alexander Ward,
Vera Bergengruen
and Anat Peled

Iran, declaring that both sides had agreed to stop fighting and that Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu had called off attacks in Lebanon. Hezbollah agreed to the terms, according to Lebanon's embassy in Washington. Netanyahu said he would attack

"terror targets in Beirut" if Hezbollah continued targeting Israel. Israeli forces would continue operating in southern Lebanon, Netanyahu added.

"Let's see how long that lasts — Hopefully it will be for ETERNITY!" Trump posted later on Monday.

Trump's maneuvering, which included a phone call to Netanyahu, appeared to be aimed at preventing U.S. negotiations with Iran from collapsing. The fighting in Lebanon

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◆ **U.S. presses Oman to cut ties with Iran**..... **A6**

More Professionals Hit Midcareer Ceiling

By LINDSAY ELLIS

No promotion. No notable raises. Not yet 40. You aren't alone.

About a quarter of American professionals hit a wall in their careers before their peak earning years, going at least five years without a real boost in pay or position.

That is the central finding of a new study tracking the careers of 1.3 million midcareer professionals across a range of industries since 2000. It suggests that even in an economy with high employment, many workers run into an invisible barrier to upward mobility just when their careers are supposed to gain momentum.

Midcareer stalls often start as early career slumps and can ripple across a lifetime of

earnings, the analysis found. That makes those first working years after college especially critical for gaining the experience and skills that propel a career forward.

"When you're talking about a quarter of the workforce, you're not talking about a niche problem," said Matt Singelman, president of the Burning Glass Institute think tank, which conducted the study with New York University's School of Professional Studies.

The research complicates the picture of today's job market. Even during the pandemic hiring spree, the midcareer stall persisted, researchers found. Now, hiring has slowed to a trickle, and companies from Amazon.com to Meta Platforms and United Parcel

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